

Our Ancestor

The First of Us. The Last of Them.

To find one child, they must answer to a billion grandkids.

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TAGLINES

To find one child, they must answer to a billion grandkids.

13,000 years ago, they lost their family. Now, everyone in the world is family.

LOGLINE

To reunite with their family, a prehistoric hunter and a woolly mammoth must face a world full of their grandchildren.

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BERING

A hunter (no discernable gender and who we'll call "Bering") from the Yana tribe stalks a mammoth herd across the prehistoric Beringia land bridge. At some point, Bering corners a baby mammoth until it levitates. The hunt takes a surreal turn when Bering also begins to levitate, abducted by a spacecraft. As the ship ascends, Bering's last sight of Earth is their partner and child desperately chasing after them.

While imprisoned in a ginormous vessel designed to collect specimens for an intergalactic zoo, Bering bonds with the mammoth, naming them Yana after their lost tribe. In their cell, Bering carves charcoal-style sketches of the land bridge, bridging the gap between their primitive origins and high-tech cage.

The captors put Bering and Yana in a cage match to the death where Bering seizes the moment. They stage a breakout, freeing every captive and seizing control of the ship, which drifts to a stop dangerously close to a black hole. Over the following years, Bering masters the vessel's technology. Though Bering and Yana initially fall ill to extraterrestrial pathogens, a fellow captive, who is an alien disease expert, bioengineers their immune systems, making them virtually invulnerable to disease.

Driven by the hope of reuniting with their family and returning Yana to their herd, Bering navigates the ship to the other captives' planets then back to Earth. However, they arrive in the modern era. The Beringia land bridge has vanished, replaced by the sea separating Russia and Alaska.

Equipped with a smaller aircraft gifted by the ship's remaining crew, Bering and a now-adolescent Yana (large enough to be ridden) land in a world they don't recognize. Despite their primitive origins, Bering is ironically now more technologically advanced than any modern human.

Yana finds a herd of modern elephants, though they remain an outsider, drawing the confused attention of safari guides. Meanwhile, a genealogist conducting a blood test discovers that Bering is a genetic root and is a direct ancestor to hundreds of millions of people on Earth.

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PILOT EPISODE

13,000 years ago, a prehistoric hunter Bering and a baby woolly mammoth Yana are abducted by an alien spacecraft from the Beringia land bridge. They return in 2030, on Little Diomedede Island, where their primitive appearance and alien tech cause conflict with local villagers.

Meanwhile, geneticist Dr. Amber Dawks analyzes blood found at the landing site and discovers that Bering is a genetic root for billions of modern humans. After running a personal test, Dawks identifies a DNA match to Bering, confirming a connection to the time-traveling hunter.

After their ship runs out of fuel in Kazakhstan, a local family shelters Bering and Yana. They struggle with modern life, mistaking a tv for a magic box with people trapped in them. At a feast, Bering uses gravy to paint a mural on a tablecloth, telling a 13,000-year journey through an intergalactic zoo, revolt, and an eventual return to a world where the land bridge is gone.

The pilot concludes with a police raid on the family's home following a mishap at a local market. Yana smashes through the house's walls, allowing Bering to mount the mammoth and escape into the night. Meanwhile, Dr. Dawks tracks new genetic markers appearing in Kazakhstan, setting the stage for a pursuit of our ancestor.